

BUG REPORT

Stale Scanner Reference Causes Misleading “No Check Detected” Error

Module: Agent POS → Check Cashing → Scan Check step

Environment: Test (agent.testreliance.com/main-dashboard/check-cashing)

Reported By: Arslan (QA)

Severity: High (blocks transaction flow with a misleading recovery path)

Status: Open – Needs Development Review

1. Summary

When the scanner device saved in application storage is unplugged, damaged, or replaced with a different physical scanner, the Scan Check screen still attempts to use the stale stored device. The scan fails, but the resulting error message (“No check was detected in the scanner. Insert the check into the scanner and press Retry.”) does not reflect the actual cause. The user is not told that the previously selected scanner is unavailable, nor that the scanner list needs to be refreshed via the small refresh icon next to the dropdown. There is currently no in-app indication that this icon is the required recovery action.

2. Steps to Reproduce

1. Select and use a scanner (e.g. TW-Brother DS-740D) on the Scan Check screen so it is saved as the last-used device.
2. Disconnect that scanner (simulating removal/damage) and connect a different scanner to the workstation.
3. Navigate to Agent POS → Check Cashing → Scan Check for any customer.
4. Observe that the scanner dropdown still lists the disconnected device, and no automatic re-detection occurs.
5. Attempt to scan a check.

3. Expected vs. Actual Result

Expected

The application detects that the previously selected scanner is no longer connected and either (a) automatically switches to an available connected scanner with a clear notice, or (b) prompts the user to pick a currently connected scanner — before a scan is even attempted.

Actual

The application silently attempts to use the stale scanner reference. The scan fails and the generic popup below is shown, which implies a paper-handling problem rather than a device-selection problem:

⚠ No check was detected in the scanner.
Insert the check into the scanner and press Retry.
[Cancel] [Retry]

Retrying does not resolve the issue because the app is still targeting the disconnected device. The fix (clicking the small refresh icon next to the scanner dropdown) is not discoverable without prior knowledge from administration.

4. Root Cause Analysis

The last-used scanner ID is persisted in application/local storage and is treated as a guarantee that the device exists and is ready, rather than as a preference that may no longer be valid. On loading the Scan Check screen, the app does not re-validate the stored scanner ID against a live list of currently connected devices, so:

- The dropdown continues to display a device that is no longer physically present.
- The scan call is issued against a device the scanner bridge/driver can no longer reach.
- The resulting failure is not distinguished from a genuine “no document in feeder” failure, so the same generic message is shown for both.

5. Recommended Fix (Development)

5.1 Validate, don't trust, on load

When the Scan Check screen mounts, query the scanner bridge/service for the live list of currently connected devices and check whether the stored scanner ID is present in that list, rather than assuming it is still valid.

5.2 Define fallback behavior for a missing stored scanner

- Auto-switch: automatically select the first currently connected device and show a brief notice, e.g. “Previously used scanner unavailable — switched to [device name].” Best fit if a station typically has one active scanner.
- Forced reselection: open the scanner dropdown pre-populated with the live device list and require the user to confirm a device before scanning. Safer if a station may have multiple scanners connected.

This is a product decision to confirm with the team — flagged here for a decision, not assumed.

5.3 Refresh the device list automatically, not manually

Re-enumerate connected devices each time the Scan Check screen loads, and again immediately before a scan attempt is fired, instead of relying on the user to notice and click the manual refresh icon.

5.4 Event-driven refresh (ideal, if supported)

If the local scanner bridge/service supports device connect/disconnect events, subscribe to them so the device list updates in real time while the user is on the screen, with no reload or manual refresh required.

5.5 Separate the underlying error codes

Confirm with development whether the scan driver/SDK already returns distinct error codes for “device not found / unreachable” versus “no document in feeder” versus “jam.” If distinct codes are available, the UI should branch and show a tailored message per cause (see Section 6) rather than collapsing all failures into one popup. If the current implementation cannot distinguish them, a single combined message should be used as a fallback, worded as a checklist rather than implying one specific cause.

6. Suggested Error Messaging

6.1 Scanner unavailable (device-selection failure)

*⚠ Scanner “TW-Brother DS-740D” is not connected.
Click ↻ to refresh the scanner list, then select an available device.*

6.2 No document detected (acquisition failure, correct device)

⚠ No check was detected in the scanner.
Check that it is properly seated in the tray and press Retry.

6.3 Combined fallback (only if error codes cannot be distinguished)

⚠ No check was detected. Please check:

1. The check is properly seated in the scanner tray.
2. The correct scanner is selected above — click ↻ to refresh if you've changed devices.

7. Test Scenarios to Cover

#	Scenario	Expected Behavior
1	Correct scanner connected, no check in tray	Shows “no document” message; correct device remains selected
2	Correct scanner connected, check misaligned/jammed	Shows document-acquisition message distinct from “no device” case, if driver supports it
3	Previously selected scanner disconnected, different scanner connected	App detects mismatch before/at scan attempt; shows device-unavailable message or auto-switches per 5.2
4	No scanner connected at all	Shows a message distinct from the above, indicating no device is available to select

8. Impact if Unresolved

- Agents cannot complete check-cashing transactions when a scanner is swapped, without informal knowledge passed down outside the application.
- The misleading message risks agents assuming a hardware fault with the check itself, rather than a software device-selection issue.